

HackAgents BIU Hackathon 2026 Guidelines

Event Overview

The HackAgents BIU Hackathon is a 24-hour intensive development event focused on building intelligent agent-based systems powered by large language models (LLMs). Participants will prototype and develop novel solutions addressing real-world challenges through agentic workflows.

-  **Date** (Scheduled for May 14–15, 2026)
-  **Place** (BIU Computer Science Building, Common Area)
- **Duration:** 24 Hours

Guidelines for Participants

1. Eligibility and Team Formation

- **CS Students:** Open to second-year students and above.
- **Engineering Students:** Open to third-year students and above.
- **Graduate Students:** M.Sc. and PhD students are encouraged to participate.
- **Teams:** Recommended team size is 2–4 members.

2. Technical Scope

- **Agentic Frameworks:** Projects must demonstrate "agentic" behavior, such as autonomous planning, tool use, or recursive self-improvement loops.
- **Models:** Teams may use any frontier models (e.g., Claude, GPT, Gemini) or open-weight alternatives like MiniMax or Qwen.
- **Originality:** All code must be written during the 24-hour period. Use of pre-existing libraries and open-source frameworks is permitted, but the core agent logic must be original.

3. Submission Requirements

Participants must submit the following by the end of the 24-hour period:

- **GitHub Repository:** A link to the project repository containing a clear **README .md** as well as all code and markdown files used to operate the agent.
- **Live Demo/Video:** A 5-minute live demonstration showing the agent performing its intended task.

4. Hackathon Ideas

You can either come up with your own idea

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1uEzmPq3hQL507EsKI7xB_JFkwGUVHDTI0HvPlzLt-HA/edit?usp=sharing

Guidelines for Judges

1. Evaluation Criteria

Judges should evaluate projects based on the following four pillars:

Category	Description	Weight
Technical Execution	Sophistication of agentic loops, effective tool/API integration, and code quality.	20%
Innovation & Novelty	The degree to which the solution solves a new problem or applies agents in a unique way.	20%
Impact & Utility	Real-world applicability and the potential to automate complex research or operational tasks.	25%

Category	Description	Weight
User Experience (UX)	The "feel" of the agent, its tact in communication, and how well it understands human intent.	20%
Evaluation	Assessment of the agent against an evaluation benchmark (either developed during the hackathon, or using an existing one).	15%

2. Judging Process

1. **In-Person Assessment and Discussion:** Judges will circulate among the teams to talk to them, get their impressions, and assess the project's technical depth and challenges overcome.
2. **Interactive Demo:** Teams will provide an interactive demonstration of their agent, followed by a brief Q&A session with the judges.
3. **Deliberation:** Judges will confer privately to finalize scores, select winners for the primary prizes, and choose any sponsor-specific challenge recipients.